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80,000 Hours: Thank you for filling out our career planning tool

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Hi there,

Thanks for working through part 2 of our career planning tool! Your answers are below.

Thank you & have a nice day!

The 80,000 Hours team

- **How confident are you in your shortlist of longer-term career options?**

I have 2-5 good options, but I'm unsure which is best.

- **Plan A: How can you try out your 2-5 options over the next few years?**

Over the next few years, I will test my career options by:

Speaking with experienced HR professionals in each area.
Taking short courses in HR management, recruitment, employee relations, and training.
Volunteering for different HR responsibilities at work.
Supporting recruitment interviews and onboarding activities.
Helping to organise employee training programmes.
Gaining experience in handling employee concerns and workplace policies.
Requesting opportunities to work with senior HR managers.
Reviewing my strengths and interests after each experience.

I will first explore general HR roles, then move towards HR management or HR business partnering.

- **What might go wrong while pursuing plan A?**

Possible challenges include:

Limited opportunities to gain experience in every HR area.
Difficulty balancing work, studies, and professional training.
Choosing a specialisation before fully understanding the role.
Lack of support or mentoring from experienced HR professionals.
Financial costs related to courses and qualifications.
Changes in the job market or organisational needs.
Discovering that some HR roles do not match my strengths or interests.

- **Plan B: What are the best nearby alternatives to plan A? If your plan A goes wrong, what will you do instead?**

If Plan A does not work, my best alternatives are:

Move into HR administration or payroll.
Work in recruitment or talent acquisition.
Specialise in employee training and development.
Consider office administration or operations management.
Gain additional HR qualifications and try again later.

These options still use my communication, organisation, and people-management skills.

- **Plan Z: What will you do if everything goes wrong, in order to buy yourself time to get back on your feet?**

If everything goes wrong, I will:

Take a temporary HR administration, office, or customer-service job.

Reduce unnecessary expenses and use my savings carefully.
 Stay with family until I become financially stable.
 Continue applying for suitable HR positions.
 Complete affordable HR courses while rebuilding my career.
 Use my professional contacts to find new opportunities.

- **1. What are your key uncertainties about your A/B/Z plan?**

My key uncertainties are:

Which HR specialisation best matches my strengths and interests?
 Whether I will enjoy the responsibilities and pressure of an HR Manager role.
 Which qualifications will provide the greatest career benefit.
 How I can gain enough practical experience in different HR functions.
 Whether HR Business Partner or Learning and Development roles offer better long-term growth.
 How changes in technology and AI may affect future HR careers.

The most useful question would be:

“What experience and qualifications should I prioritise to become a successful HR Manager?”

My plan could be proven wrong if practical experience shows that HR management does not suit my abilities, interests, or preferred working style.

- **2. What are you going to do to resolve these uncertainties?**

To resolve these uncertainties, I will:

Speak with experienced HR Managers and HR Business Partners.
 Review job descriptions for my preferred HR roles.
 Take short online courses in HR management and employee relations.
 Volunteer for recruitment, training, and employee-engagement tasks.
 Ask for feedback from my manager or mentor.
 Compare the qualifications required for senior HR positions.
 Review my progress after gaining practical experience.

- **How are you going to put your plan into action? List out your most important next steps.**

Even if you're not entirely sure about your plan, it's helpful to make a list of concrete next steps you're going to take to put it into action. Big career moves are much less intimidating once broken down.

If you revise your plan, you can come back and update this list.

My most important next steps are:

Update my CV and LinkedIn profile by 15 August 2026.
 Speak with at least two experienced HR professionals before the end of August 2026.
 Ask my current manager for more involvement in recruitment, onboarding, training, and employee relations.
 Enrol in a short HR management course by September 2026.
 Review five HR Manager and HR Business Partner job descriptions to identify skill gaps.
 Attend at least one HR networking event or webinar every two months.
 Build practical experience by leading a small employee-engagement or training project.
 Request feedback from an HR mentor or manager every three months.
 Apply for suitable HR opportunities through professional contacts and referrals.
 Review my progress and career direction in February 2027.

- **Does your plan involve talking to someone?**

Yes

- **Nice, now you have a list of clear next steps. The final thing is to set some review points to make sure you follow through.**

What signs would show this plan is wrong?

Signs that my plan may be wrong include:

I consistently dislike HR responsibilities after gaining practical experience.
 My strengths do not match the communication, decision-making, and conflict-management demands of HR.
 I make little progress in developing the required HR skills or qualifications.

I receive repeated feedback that another career area may suit me better.
There are limited opportunities for growth in my chosen HR specialisation.
The role negatively affects my well-being or work-life balance.
I do not gain additional responsibility or career progress within 12–18 months.

I will review my plan every six months and complete a major reassessment in February 2027.

- **When are you next going to review your plan?**

2028/01/01

- **Would you like us to email you your plan?**

No

- **Enter your email address**

sharvani.jayaseelan@gmail.com

- **How likely are you to recommend this career planning tool to a friend or colleague?**

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